A HANDS-ON WORKSHOP

Beyond AI Slop.

Building better interfaces with design systems

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START HERE

The workshop studio.

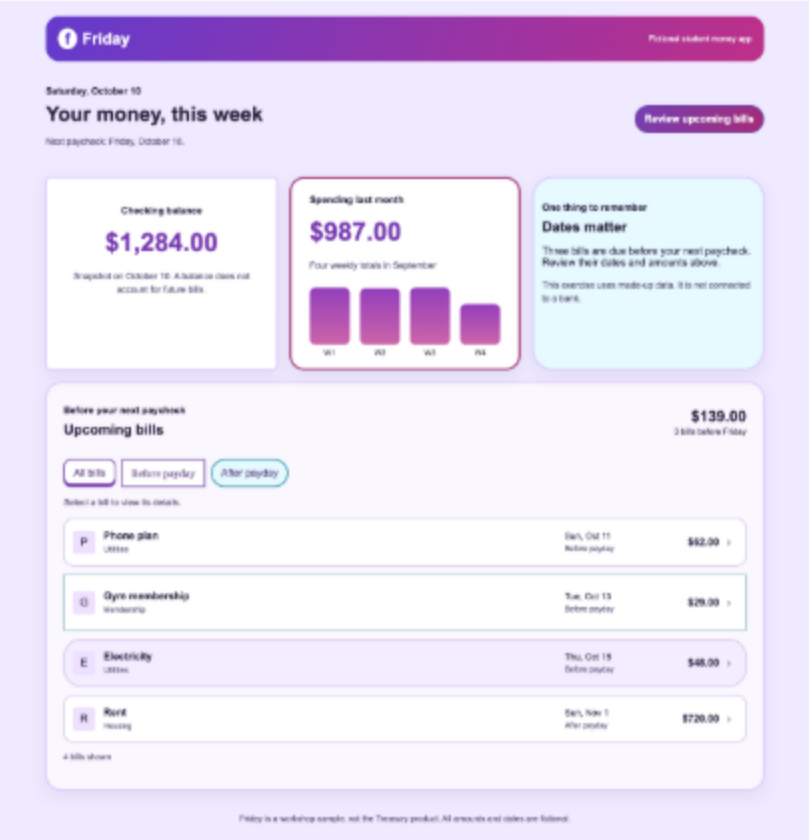
juneadkhan.github.io/ hacknc-beyond-ai-slop/

No setup for the studio

Browser + your AI chat. Nothing to install.

No AI access? Use a reference and change its tokens.

The user's task.



Which bills are due before Friday?

Find the dates and amounts.

Same task for every style.

Observable interface problems.

Hierarchy

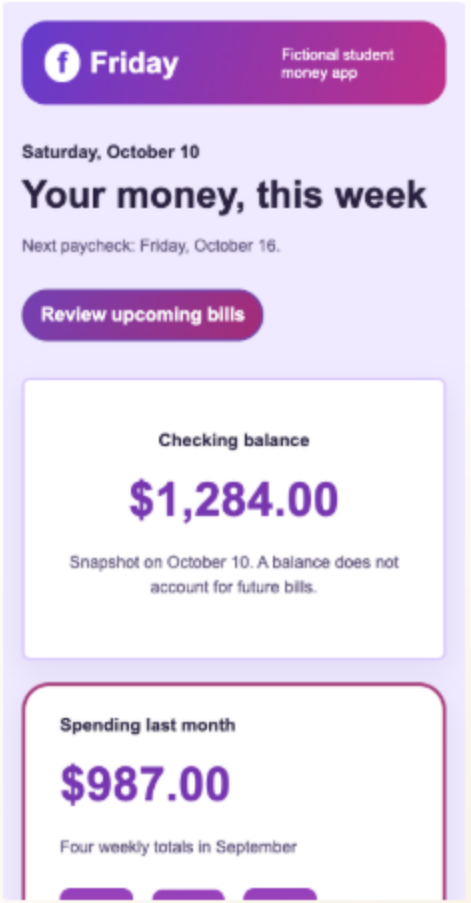
The secondary metrics get attention before bill dates.

Component rules

Three filters look like three unrelated controls.

Small screens

The important list moves below secondary content.



A system AI can reuse.

01

Purpose

Find bills before payday.

02

Tokens

Name roles, then assign values.

03

Components

Reuse rows, filters and panels.

04

Rules

Define priority, states and mobile.

A shared system still leaves room for your own taste.

Semantic tokens.

```
:root {
  --surface: #ffffff;
  --text: #1c303c;
  --accent: #214e63;
  --on-accent: #ffffff;
  --space-4: 16px;
}
```

```
.button-primary {
  background: var(--accent);
  color: var(--on-accent);
  padding: var(--space-4);
}
```

One shared decision can update several components.

Component rules.

Bill rows

Same date, amount and spacing rules for every bill.

Buttons and filters

Default, hover, selected and visible keyboard focus.

Responsive hierarchy

Bills remain first; amounts stay beside their own bill.

Existing design systems.

Carbon

IBM’s product system

Foundations, components and usage guidance.

Fluent 2

Microsoft’s design system

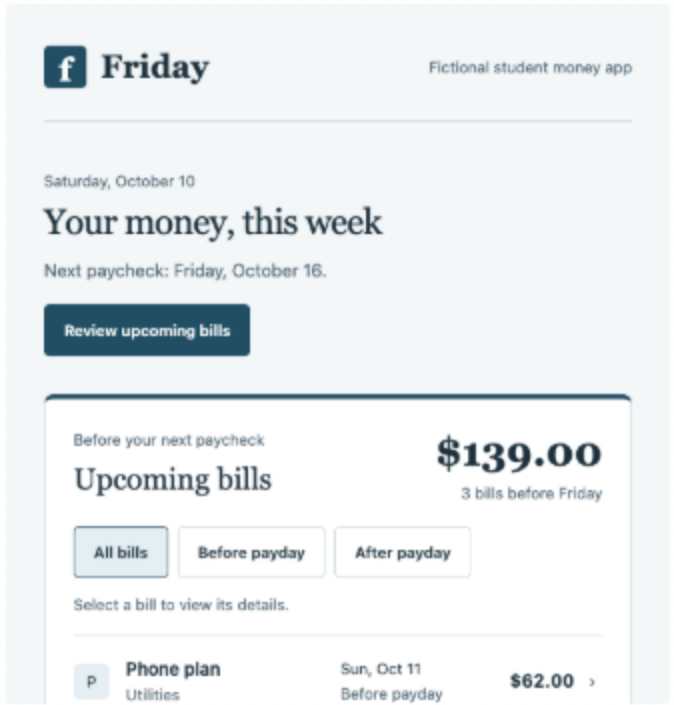
Resources and components for several platforms.

Radix Primitives

Unstyled behaviors

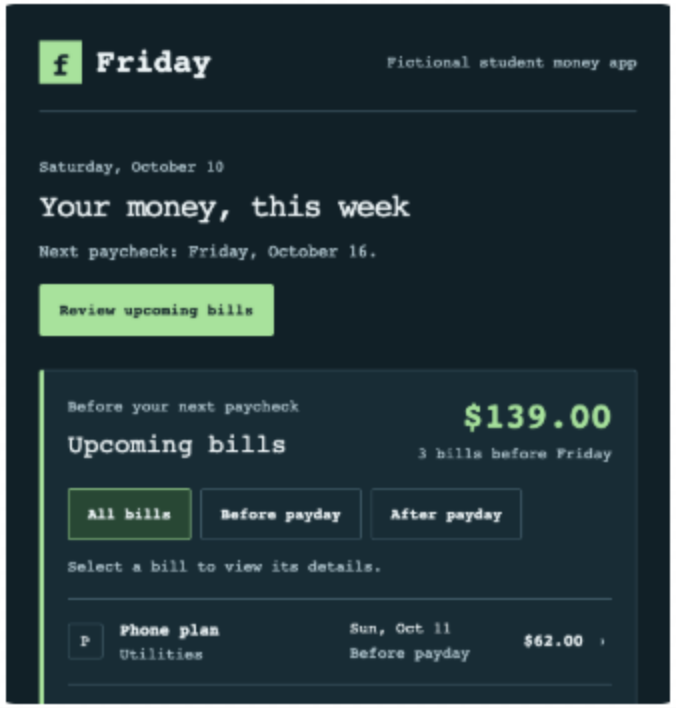
Accessible building blocks; you supply visual rules.

Three distinct directions.



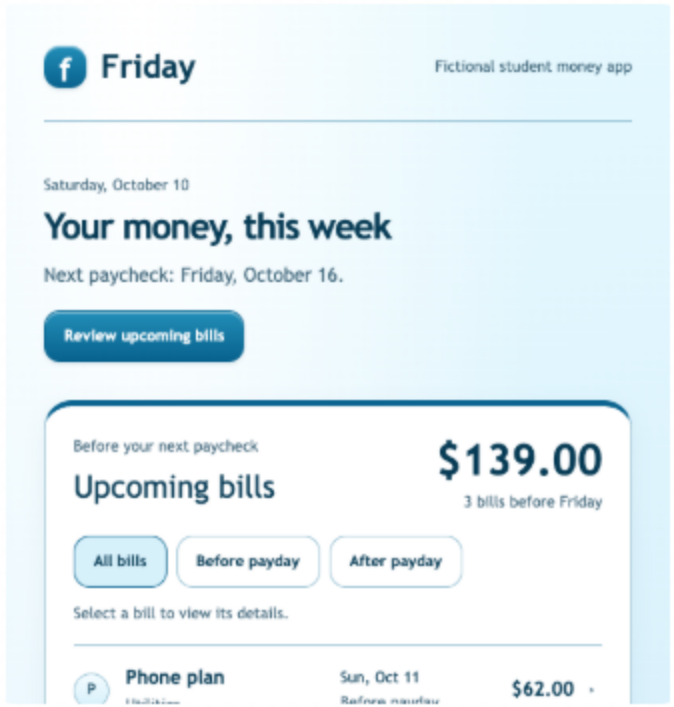
Ledger

Quiet reading



Signal

Technical clarity



Aero

Optimistic gloss

LIVE REDESIGN · 6 MINUTES

Guide, then implementation.

1 Create and review the guide

Purpose, tokens, component rules, states and mobile.

2 Apply one complete stylesheet

Use the fixed DOM and facts. Inspect the rendered app.

3 Revise a specific observed failure

“At 390px, the date wraps away from its amount.”

BUILD · 12 MINUTES

Your style. One working app.

Choose a point of view

Audience + mood + typography + density + priority.

Generate, review, apply

A design guide, then a complete CSS stylesheet.

Check mobile and keyboard

Keep every amount, date, filter and detail dialog.

12

minutes

No AI access?
Use a reference
and change tokens.

PEER TEST · 6 MINUTES

A test with your neighbor.

Give your partner the task

“Find every bill due before Friday. Open one.”

Look for evidence

Dates and amounts, shared rules, 390px, keyboard.

Share one rule and one remaining issue

What improved? What still gets in the user’s way?

Design systems in your own hack.

Write the task and save the guide

Give your coding agent rules it can keep returning to.

Reuse components; change one thing at a time

Inspect the rendered result before moving on.

Make trustworthy information easy to use

A clear date and amount matter more than decoration.

EXPORT AND CONTINUE

Your app. Your design system.

Download your app + your design guide

Keep the working interface and the decisions behind it.

Which rule will you use in your hack?

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